

Default browsers used by major mobile phone vendors

- m Nokia Series 40 Browser by Nokia
- m Nokia S60 Browser by Nokia
- m Web Browser for S60 by Nokia
- m Opera by Opera Software ASA (Norway)
- m Pocket Internet Explorer by Microsoft

User-installable microbrowsers

- m WinWAP by Winwap Technologies (winwap.com)
- m Minimo by the Mozilla Foundation
- m Palm Web Browser Pro by PalmOne
- m Pixa by Sun Microsystems
- m Opera Mini by Opera

4.4.3 i-Mode

i-Mode is a wireless Internet service that's hugely popular in Japan. It was inspired by WAP developed in the US and was introduced by NTT DoCoMo, Japan's largest cellular service provider. After a two-year development, i-Mode was launched in Japan in February of 1999.

Opposed to the WAP standard which utilises WML on top of a specific protocol stack for wireless handheld devices, i-Mode borrows from fixed Internet data formats such as C-HTML, as well as DoCoMo proprietary protocols ALP (HTTP) and TLP (TCP, UDP). It became a runaway success because of the well-designed services and business model, as well as the strong need at the time for a text messaging service.

i-Mode is now a global ecosystem where operators design the compatible handsets, give strong editorial and usability rules to content providers, and propose an open business model to them. i-Mode uses open standards as technologies: a light version of HTML is used for producing content, and i-Mode mail is interoperable with e-mail, images and sound formats used on the Web. i-Mode users have access to various services such as e-mail, sports results, weather forecasts, games, financial services and ticket booking.